preparing itself not just for COVID-19 but for the economic devastation that's coming. I am saying it again and again. I am sorry to say this but our people are going to go through unimaginable pain in the next six months.' He added, 'I will tell you a story… In Andaman and Nicobar, before the tsunami came, the water went out. When the water went out, everybody went to get the fish. When they went, the water (levels) came up. I have been warning the government. They are fooling around… they are not clear about what to do. Coronavirus is like a tsunami.'[19]

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In perhaps the most difficult speech to give in his tenure, the prime minister was scheduled to be on national television in the later part of the day to prepare the country for the tough days that lay ahead. Effectively communicating key points was absolutely crucial, now more than ever. As he sat down with his speech writers deliberating the important points which should absolutely find mention, one of the challenges was to explain the concept of social distancing to the people. How does one even begin to explain to the people who live in such congested, interconnected societies like ours that staying physically apart from each other would be a lifesaver? Like all of his national addresses, Hindi would be the language of delivery. But in Hindi, social distancing literally translates to '*samaajik doori*'. *Samaajik doori* has negative connotations as it alludes to creating a distance between social classes in our caste-based system, so using that literal translation would certainly not be appropriate. On further thought, he suggested that he use the term '*do gaj ki doori*' instead, which in English translates to a 'two-yard distance'.

To accurately depict the seriousness of the situation, he would have to allude to a human tragedy of this scale and thus he would make a reference to the World Wars I and II, in which even, these many countries were not impacted as were by the novel coronavirus. He would also use the war analogy to remind senior citizens about times of blackout where towns and cities would turn off all lights in the night and restrict movement so as not to be spotted by enemy planes from the skies.

He would have to be a commander-in-chief, a unifier and a consoler-in-chief who India can trust with their lives.